

Ian Cowpar

PM building at principal scope | AI-fluent prototyping | data products with opinion | zero-translation systems

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SUMMARY

Senior PM building data products, AI tooling, and self-serve flows at enterprise scale. Two years at UKG protecting 300 enterprise customers (\$250M ARR) through migration off legacy workforce management — built the data products that let services and engineering catch problems before customers felt them, scaled UKG product's first organized AI capability layer without a top-down mandate, and shipped a 0→1 migration tool with the prototype I wrote myself in Claude Code. Ten years prior at Broadridge: 40+ enterprise deployments in compliance-grade financial services.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Manager Jun 2024 – Apr 2026

UKG | Lowell, MA | \$250M ARR | Data products, AI tooling, and self-serve flows protecting enterprise customers through migration

- **Built a 0→1 self-serve migration tool, idea to production.** Took it from concept through three business-epic decomposition (UI, rules, deployment), wrote the working prototype myself in Claude Code, designed the UX feedback loop and persona, and handed engineering the full delivery package — bepics, epics, stories, Gantt, roadmap. Now in active production; the Services org runs migrations independently without an engineering ticket.
- **Built UKG product's first organized AI capability layer.** Started as a personal automation library, scaled into team-wide shared capability without a top-down mandate — standardizing and automating product-development mechanisms to increase team throughput. Adoption spread because the thing worked better than what it replaced — the only kind of adoption that lasts.
- **Designed a five-panel operational analytics product** classifying open issues across customer escalations, code defects, internal bugs, CVEs, and noise across four products; auto-refreshed daily, with a Claude Code function I built into the tool surfacing the single highest-leverage action per panel. Opinionated routing, not a dashboard.
- **Designed sprint health instrumentation** refreshing every 15 minutes across two engineering teams, with documented rejection criteria for burndown, velocity, and story-point anti-patterns — each with technical rationale. Built for signal, not ceremony.
- **Led ARR-focused risk tracking for the UTA upgrade program:** automated weekly reporting routes every open blocker to the program lead; live tracking surfaces aging issues before escalation.
- **Served as the product-side voice on enterprise customer escalation and pre-upgrade calls** — synthesizing what 300 UTA customers (\$250M ARR) actually needed versus what was on the roadmap, feeding that gap back into prioritization decisions.

Brand Champion, UKG North America Regional Lead 2026 | Fire Up ERG (women and allies), Business Innovation workstream lead

Business Analyst Jan 2014 – Jun 2024

Broadridge Financial Solutions | Andover, MA

- Led 40+ enterprise client deployments end-to-end in a compliance-grade financial services environment; developed strong instincts for regulatory consequence, requirements quality, and the difference between a delivery that closes and a product that keeps producing.
- Internal SME for an omni-channel communication product adopted across the full client base; translated complex compliance capabilities into workflows non-technical buyers could operate without support.

Sr. Document Development Analyst Jan 2006 – Jan 2014

SKILLS AND FOCUS AREAS

Product: Roadmap strategy and definition, end-to-end product delivery, portfolio tradeoff decisions, 0→1 product building, data products, MVP definition, customer discovery, B2B SaaS

AI as Co-Builder: Claude Code prototyping, agentic workflows, AI-fluent product development, PM automation, process standardization and throughput, zero-translation building

Data & Analytics: Operational analytics products, opinionated instrumentation, KPI definition, automated reporting cadence, qualitative-to-structured synthesis, weekly/monthly business reporting

Compliance & Enterprise: Regulatory-consequence delivery, compliance-grade financial services, multi-stakeholder coordination, executive customer engagement, escalation room presence

Tooling: Jira, Confluence, GitHub, SQL, Slack MCP, Claude Code CLI

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Management Information Systems and Management

Manning School of Business, UMass Lowell | 1999

WRITING AND THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

The Unofficial Leader (Substack) | theunofficialleader.substack.com

Weekly publication on AI adoption, unofficial leadership, and what's happening beneath the surface of how teams work. Originator of the Zero-Translation Building framework. Active LinkedIn audience engagement on product, AI adoption, and team dynamics.